

including the bedroom. So often you'd be sitting in bed with your laptop on a pillow or precariously balancing it on you lap in weird kamasutra-like poses, wondering there must be a better way. Well there is. The Choiix Ucool notebook pad is designed specifically for this purpose. Available in your choice of blue, black, or green, it is an ergonomically designed pad for when you want to use your laptop in bed or on the couch. The curvy design allows for adequate airflow beneath your notebook and, at the same time, the Ucool is stiff enough to provide sufficient support.

THE WEIRD STUFF

Neutrano's Wrist phone

Every tech show apparently must have a wristwatch phone. Like some sort of a James Bond fantasy that must be fulfilled. This is the kind of gadget we were referring to when we said you will find products at CES that'll make you wonder if they really are useful. Nevertheless they are hi-tech. This piece of spy inspired equipment looks like a standard chunky black watch but has a 1.4-inch, 160x128 TFT LCD touchscreen. A standard phone keypad curves halfway over the wrist band while there is a speaker over the screen. It has a media player, 4 GB of space and fm and all that kind of guy stuff but at a price tag of \$250-300, we seriously wonder if anyone will willingly pick it up. Another notable mention in this category is the LG GD910 Watch Phone.



A PHONE?

A Projector?

Everything seems to be fusing with phones at CES 2009. The latest to follow the trend is the Logic Bolt. Logic Wireless the company behind the phone claims it can project a two-hour movie on a 36-64 inch screen! And from almost any source, including an Xbox or Nintendo Wii. The phone uses an LCoS (liquid crystal on silicon) projector with an LED backlight. The phone also has a 320x240 touch screen and a 3 megapixel camera. The most interesting part, apart from the projection capabilities, is the fact that it will be sold subsidized by T-Mobile for \$100. Lets make a note about this one and keep an eye on its development.



LETS ROCK

Guitar Hero Platform

At the Bayou showcased a specialized wireless Guitar Hero platform that vibrates and

surrounds you with some rocking tunes out of its built-in speakers. The vibration will surely rock your world. But the only trouble is that it's a 2 square feet platform, so you can't go Ac/Dc on it — meaning if your style is to jump around all over the stage- you can't. Other than that it should be a fun device for all the wannabe guitar heroes out there.

BLU-RAY NOW WITHIN REACH

VBR100

It's a Blu-ray player. So why is it being featured here? For its affordable under \$150 price tag. The player is being launched as a part of Vizio's effort to bring Blu-ray to a wider audience.

This is certainly good news, because it looks like the gap between DVD's and Blu-ray is narrowing. A lower price will even benefit Blu-ray disk sales. But coming back to the VBR 100 its low price doesn't appear to sacrifice much in the way of features.

The player provides 7.1-channel analogue output (using a 108MHz/11-bit Digital to analogue converter) and full decoding support for Dolby TrueHD, DTS-HD Master Audio, and PCM lossless audio formats as well as common audio formats including Dolby Digital, Dolby Digital Plus, and DTS. It will also function as DVD player capable of providing up to 1080p video output via its HDMI port. It doesn't look too bad either with its illuminated touch-sensitive front panel controls.

FROM LCD TO LED

Samsung 8000 Series 240-Hz LED HDTV

Samsung wants to focus on LED TV as its new growth engine in 2009. So although it showcased a whole lot of home theater products at CES 09, it has put a lot of emphasis on its 8000 Series of energy-efficient, megafast-motion-capable 240Hz LED-based 1080p HDTVs. LEDs offer higher contrast ratios, slimmer designs, and lower power consumption as compared to the regular LCDs. The most interesting aspect of the 8000 series is its 240Hz technology.

The cutting-edge "Auto Motion Plus" technology promises enhanced picture quality even with lightning-fast action scenes. It will be available in 46 and 55 inch variants. Its other features include "Ultra Clear Panel" for reduced reflection and increased perceived contrast which should give u great contrast even in bright light. The screens are to include built-in Ethernet along with Wi-Fi capability so that it displays widget-based content from Yahoo, Flickr, and other Web sites can be displayed through its propriety "internet@tv" service.

COMPETITION FOR THE I-POD

Samsung P3

The Samsung p3 player tries to give you something that most touch based devices